



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

PUBLIC SPEAKING

Lecture 31: Elocutions and Recitations

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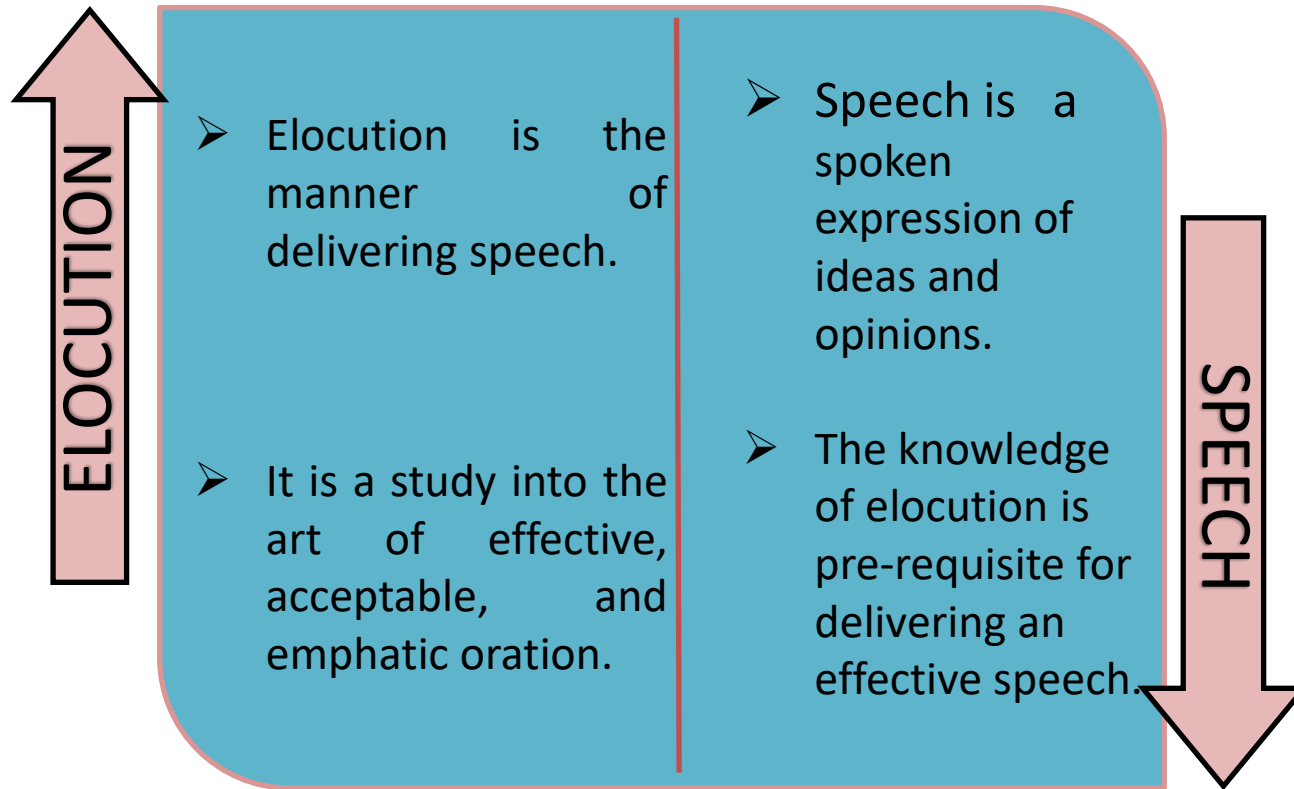


Elocution: The Art of Oration



- ❑ Elocution may be defined as the art of clear and effective expression of thought by **Speech, Intonation and Gesture**.
- ❑ Etymology – from Latin '**elocutio**' meaning oratorical or literary style
- ❑ Elocution and Recitation comprise five elements:
 - ❑ Distinct Articulation
 - ❑ Correct Pronunciation
 - ❑ Emphasis by Accentuation and Intonation
 - ❑ Emotional Expressiveness
 - ❑ Appropriate Gesticulation

Elocution versus Speech

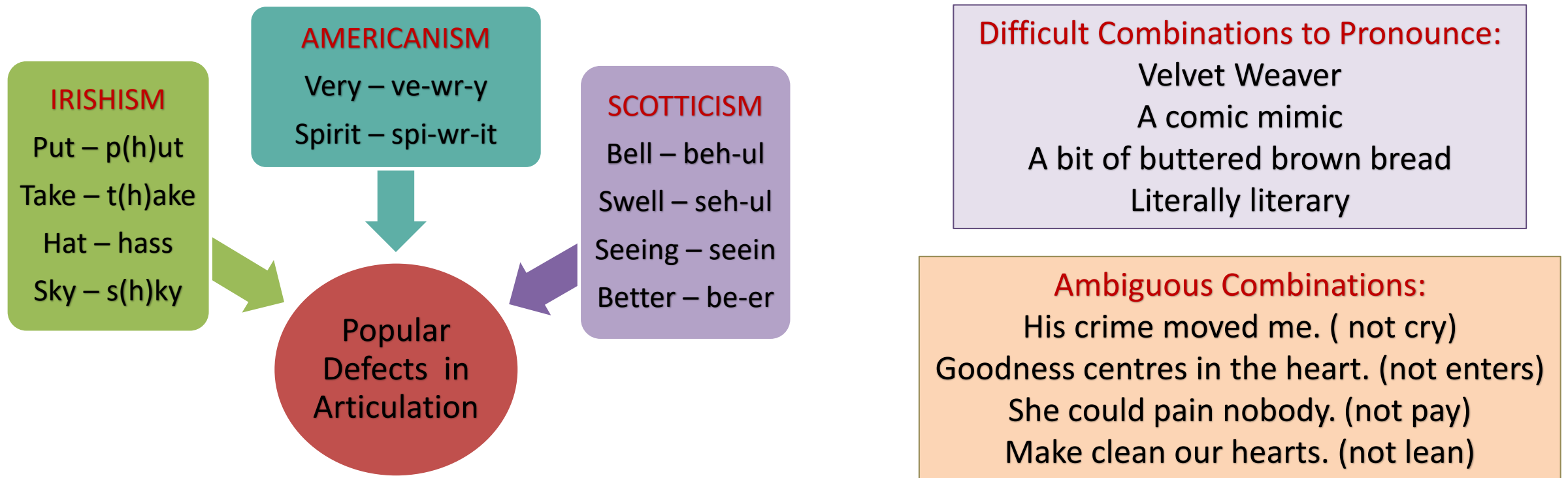


- ❑ Public Speaking, or the skill of oration involves twin constituents:
 - ❑ **The matter, or, the Speech**
 - ❑ **The manner, or, the Art of Elocution**
- ❑ **Matter** is the native unquarried rock, whereas, manner is the tool to transform it into 'a sculptured palace'.
(Alexander Melville Bell, *The Principles of Elocution*)
- ❑ Thus, **manner or elocutionary art**, is the manifestation of all matter.

Pronunciation: Articulation

The finesse of correct pronunciation comprises principles of efficient respiration, perfect vocalization of consonant and vowel sounds, distinct articulation, and proper accentuation of syllables.

Orthoepy – The correct pronunciation of words



Pronunciation: Accent

- Every word of more than one syllable has at least one *stressed* syllable, made prominent by a forceful vocal effort – termed as '**accent**'.
- The accentuation of syllables in a word or words and phrases in a sentence ought to be distinctly indicated in pronunciation.

Examples of Primary Accent on:

1st Syllable – **Way**ward, **Tempo**rary
2nd Syllable – Away, Remem**ber**,
3rd Syllable – Recomm**end**, Anatom**ical**
4th Syllable – Superint**end**, Epigram**matic**
5th Syllable – Personification,
Impracticab**ility**

IF THE GH SOUND IN ENOUGH IS PRONOUNCED "F"
& THE O IN WOMEN MAKES THE SHORT "I" SOUND
& THE TI IN NATION IS PRONOUNCED "SH"
THEN THE WORD

"GHOTI"

IS PRONOUNCED JUST LIKE



"FISH"



WELCOME TO THE ENGLISH LANGUAGE

Principles of Accentuation

Accent in Words

- ❑ For the words used as both noun and verb, the noun form retains stress on the first syllable, and the verb has the second syllable as accented. (*object* – noun; *object* – verb)
- ❑ Prefixes (such as *in*, *re*, *mis*, *ab*), articles, pronouns, prepositions and conjunctions are generally non-accented.
- ❑ In case of opposite words, the accent is shifted to the syllable of difference. For example – *assent* - *dissent*; *mortality* – *immortality*.

Sentential Accent

- ❑ In the pronunciation of sentence, words are grouped into accentual groups. The accent lies on the principle word in a phrase and on the prominent idea in a sentence.
- ❑ In a sentence, words that express new ideas are accented, and those stating previously implied facts are unaccented.
- ❑ In case of antithetical ideas, the accent is on the words expressing the factor of contradiction.

Intonation

Intonation is a cultivated conversational effect achieved by an appropriate rising and falling of pitch of the voice while speaking. The **melody of speech** results from the contrasting of tones.

RISING TONE ↗

- To command attention of the hearer
- To express continuity, doubt, surprise, inquiry, or deference in a statement
- To convey attractive sentiments – pity, love
- E.g. – Are you going?

FALLING TONE ↘

- To signal the completion of a statement
- To express conviction, assurance, assertion, or command
- To convey repulsive emotions – contempt, disgust, reproach
- E.g. – I must go, at once.

COMPOUND TONE ↘↗

- **Compound Rising** (Fall-Rise tone) – To convey warning, antithesis to interrogation
- E.g. - Don't fail to report! (Warning)
- **Compound Falling** (Rise-Fall tone) – To convey sarcasm, scorn, antithesis to affirmation
- E.g. – You will find out! (Threat)

Intonation in Sentences

Sentences can be broadly classified into three categories:

- ❖ **Assertive Sentences** – They usually take a **falling tone**, except when they do not communicate information or absoluteness.
- ❖ **Interrogative Sentences** – They take a **rising tone**, except when they do not imply doubt or question. Questions that cannot be answered in a “yes” or “no” take falling tone.
- ❖ **Imperative Sentences** – They take a **falling tone** when they are absolute (as in command), and a **rising tone** when they appeal (as in supplication).

Remark: The reader mustn't be misled by the mere rhetorical construct of the sentences. Interrogative constructions may imply assertiveness and declarative construction may be interrogative in sense.

For instance, **Cassius says to Brutus:**

“I said an elder soldier – not a better – Did I say better?”

(**Assertive** in sense, hence would take a **falling tone**)

“You do not love me, Brutus.”

(**Interrogative** in implication, hence would take a **rising tone**)

Punctuation and Pausing

- To separate words or clauses in a sentence
- To disjoin explanatory clauses from the principal clause

Comma

- At the conclusion of a dependent clause
- At the end of a series of connected sentences

Semi-colon

- To join in one period sentences which are complete in themselves
- After recurrence of semicolons

Colon

- After the completion of an independent sentence
- After a series of collateral sentences

Period

- A pause is regarded as a more eloquent device than words.
- Unbroken eloquence fails to sustain the attention of the hearer; appropriate pausing rivets the audience's attention and allows them time to reflect on the delivered message.
- **Remark:** Oratorical pausing does not always coincide with the grammatical punctuation marks in a sentence.

Pauses in Oration

Pausing is of two types:

- **SENTENTIAL**: Indicated by the marks of punctuation and the syntactical structure of the sentence.
- **RHETORICAL**: Directed by the sense and feeling of the sense implied by the sentence.

TYPES OF RHETORICAL PAUSES	EXAMPLES
After the subject of a sentence	Honesty is a virtue.
In case of the inversion of a subject	The strongest of Gods was Hercules.
After words of emphasis	Simon is a good boy.
To arrest the attention	The sentence was death.
Expressive pauses	...And the winner is Edward.

Difference between Sentential Punctuation and Oratorical Pausing:

The sky—is changed!—and such a change! —O—night,
And storm, and darkness!—ye are wondrous strong,
— Yet lovely in your strength,—as is the light
Of a dark eye—in woman! —Far along,
— From peak to peak, the rattling crags among
- Leaps the live thunder! —
Thunder among the Alps by *Byron*

Quality of the Voice

PURE QUALITY

The natural human voice
For conversations, narratives,
descriptions.

*"Because you flourish in
worldly affairs,
Don't be haughty, and put on
airs,"*

- Saxe

THE OROTUND

Round and Full
To express grandeur, sublimity
*"On you noble English,
Whose blood is set from fathers
of war proof;
Cry, Heaven for Harry, England
and St. George !"*

- Shakespeare

THE PECTORAL

Low-pitched and slow
Expresses despair, anger
*"Macbeth - Still it cried, Sleep
no more, to all the house:
Glamis hath murdered sleep;
and therefore Cawdor Shall
sleep no more - Macbeth shall
sleep no more !"*

- Shakespeare

THE GUTTURAL

Explosive resonance in throat
For anger, hatred, contempt
*"How like a fawning publican he
looks !*

I hate him for he is a Christian;"

- Shakespeare

Contd...

THE PLAINTIVE

Low-pitched and emotional

Language of pity, grief

*"Farewell, O my Laughing Water!
All my heart is buried with you!"*

- Longfellow

THE ASPIRATE

Whispered vocalization

Expresses secrecy, fear

"I fear thee ancient mariner!

I fear thy skinny hand!

*And thou art long and lank and
bro wn,*

As is the ribb ' d sea sand."

- Coleridge

THE FALSETTO

High pitched, shrill

Expresses terror, pain, anger

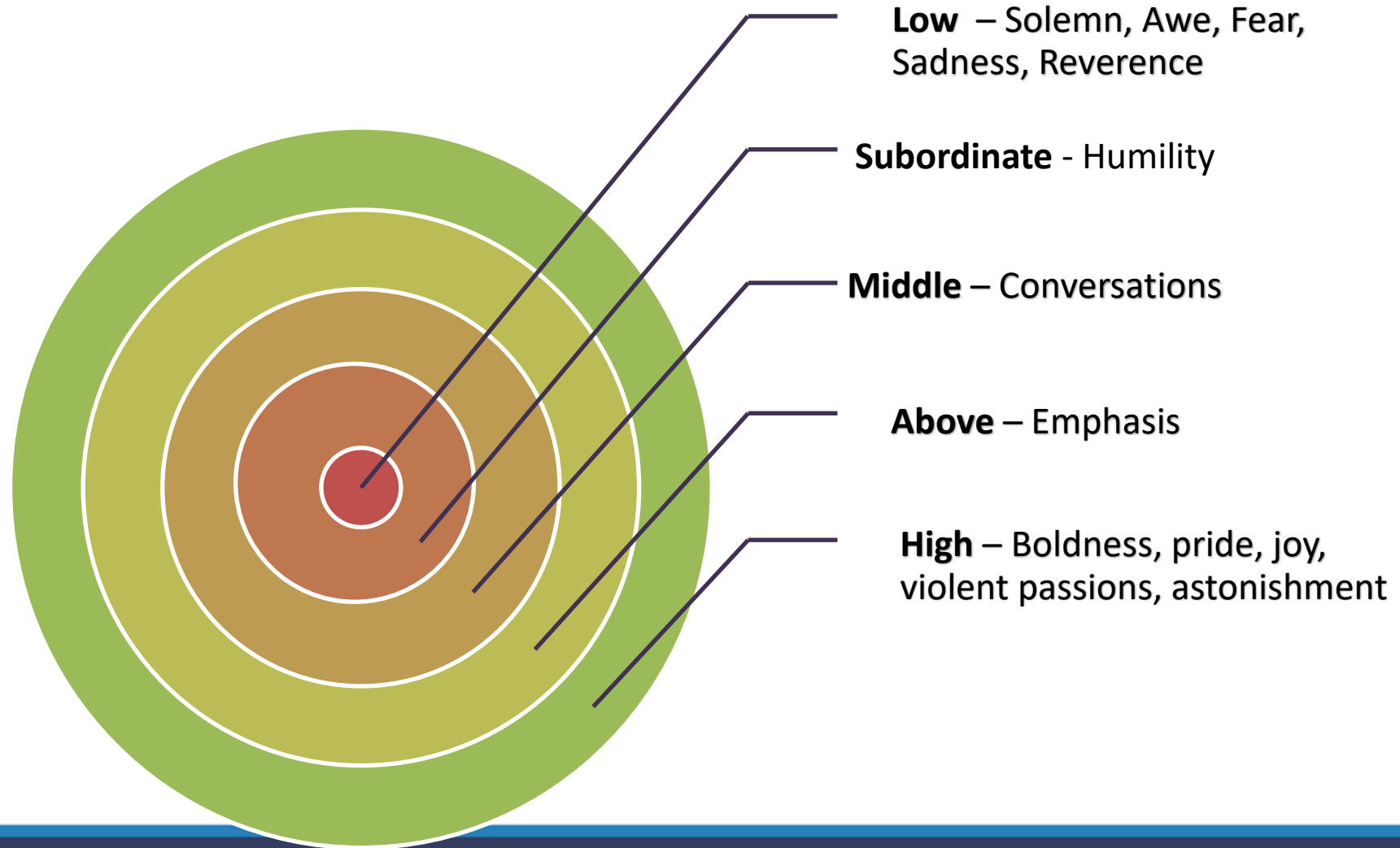
*"I'll not endure it — Duke or no
Duke — I'll be a Duchess, Sir !"*

- Honeymoon

Modulation: Pitch of the Voice

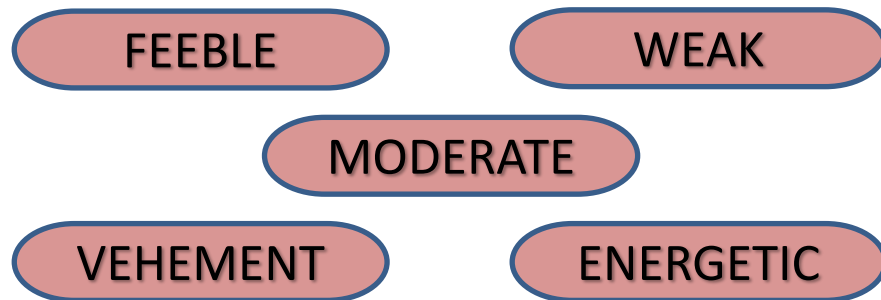
- ❑ Modulation, also referred to as pitch, is **the degree of elevation or depression of sound**. Transitions in pitch is the key to effective elocution
- ❑ Modulation produces a **pleasing variety** in speech.
- ❑ A change in pitch distinguishes:
 - ✓ The important passages
 - ✓ Questions from answers
 - ✓ Quotations
 - ✓ Change of sentiment
 - ✓ Explanatory Clauses
 - ✓ Parenthetical matter
 - ✓ Introduction of a new subject
 - ✓ Commencement of paragraph
 - ✓ Different speakers in dialogues

TYPES OF VOICE MODULATIONS

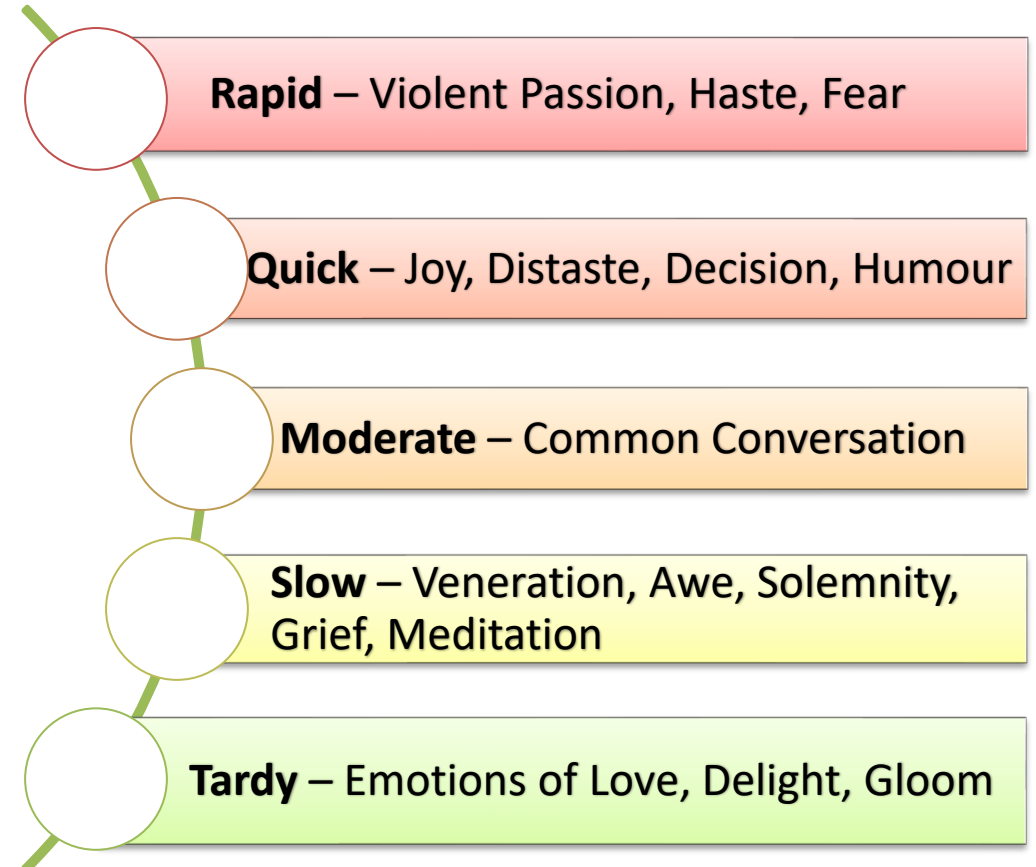


Vocal Energy: Force and Time

- **Force** : The quality of voice that depends on **pressure applied on breath** while vocalization of the sound.
- Force is an entirely different quality from pitch of the voice. A low pitch may be uttered with extreme force, or a high key with a feeble force.
- The **five degrees** of discernible forces for oration are as follows:

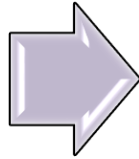


- **Time**: The rate of syllabic and sentential utterance. The five types of oratory speed are:

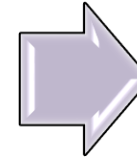


EMPHASIS IN SPEECH

Every multi-syllabic word has an *accented syllable*



Every clause has an *accented word*



Every sentence has an accented or *emphatic idea*

- Accent gives prominence to the **leading syllables in words**, and to the **words in clauses**.
- Similarly, emphasis is used to give prominence to the **leading idea in a sentence**.
- The emphasis of oration falls on the **word expressive of this leading idea**.
- The **leading idea** is always **an idea new to the context**.



EMPHASIZED

Words expressive of ideas new to the context

Words suggestive of unexpressed antithesis

Words used in contrast to a preceding term

UNEMPHASIZED

Words which are implied – which reiterate an idea already conveyed

Explanatory terms

Repetitive words – not suggesting a special meaning



Emotional Expressiveness

- ❑ An emphatic elocution comprises not only graceful and distinct articulation, but also a **sympathetic sensibility** accompanied with utterances.
- ❑ Emotional expressiveness enables the reader ***to make the sound an echo to the sense***, thereby relaying its proper effect.

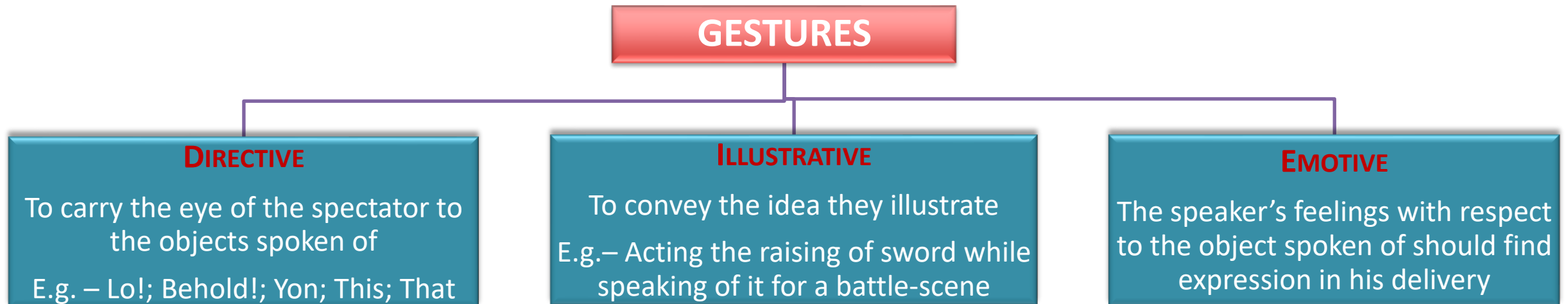
VOICE QUALITY	EMOTIONAL EXPRESSIONS
WHISPER	SECRECY, CUNNING, APPREHENSION OF EVIL, FEARFUL SUSPENSE
HOARSENESS	AGONY, DESPAIR, HORROR
MONOTONE	REFLECTION, GLOOM, MELANCHOLY
TREMOR	ANXIETY, EAGERNESS, INTENSE EMOTION
CHUCKLE	TRIUMPH, DELIGHT, MERRIMENT
RHYTHM	MUSICALITY, ALTERNATION
PROLONGATION	ADMIRATION, LONGING
STOP	MEDITATION, ANXIOUS WATCHFULNESS, TERROR

Gestures

- ❑ The proper gesticulation of the body is crucial for contributing to the full impressiveness and effectiveness of a vocal expression.

In a passionate expression, **Looks** are first, **Gestures** second, and **Words** the last. The management of gesture involves:

- ❑ **Attitude:** The Head – firm; Neck – upright; Chin – horizontal; Chest – held up; Shoulders – levelled; Arms - relaxed; Feet – moderately apart.
- ❑ **Motion** – All movements should be graceful in action and definite in expressiveness.



Gestures - Motion

HEAD

Erect – Confidence
Crouched – Fear
Shaky – Denial or
Sadness
Thrown back – Pride

EYES

Sparkle – Mirth
Flash – Anger
Stare – Wonder
Raised – Hope
Restless – Anxiety

MOUTH

Open – Fear, Wonder
Shut – Pride, Apathy
Jaws fall – Sorrow
Teeth gnashed – Anger

ARMS

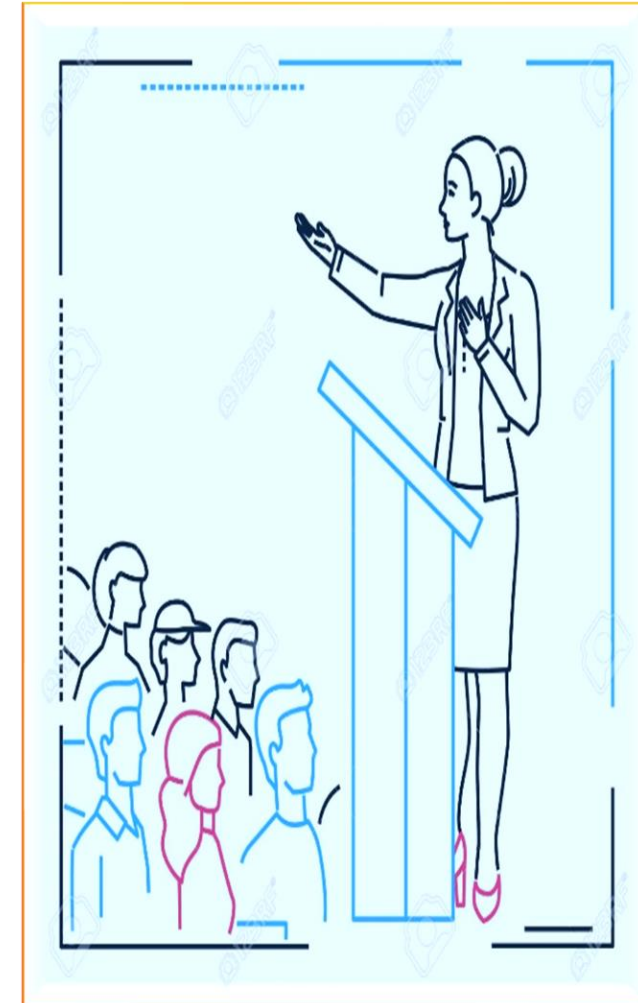
Droop – Weakness
Folded – Smugness
Extended – Welcome
Raised – Appeal
Drawn back – Aversion

BODY

Erect – Resolution
Stiff – Pride
Stooping forward –
Humility
Bending – Respect
Kneel – Prayer

LIMBS

Feet close together – Timidity
Stamping feet – Impatience
Tip-Toe Steps – Caution/
Secrecy



Graceful Gestures

The Do's

- ✓ Gestures should **appropriately suit** the action to the word (utterance).
- ✓ All parts of the body should blend in a **harmonious complement** of the gesticulating part.
- ✓ The weight of the body should be **sustained by one foot** - shifting alternately to the other.
- ✓ In **unimpassioned** subject the gesture **coincides** with vocal accent; in **violent** emotions gesture **precedes** the words.

The Don'ts

- ✗ Gestures should **not imitatively** suit the action to the word (utterance).
- ✗ Gesticulating should not be practised as a mechanical art; it must **seem natural**.
- ✗ **Inexpressive** and unnecessary gestures should be avoided
- ✗ Gestures should **not** be used to depict the **obvious literal meaning**, or for ideas that are sufficiently expressed in language.

Acing the Art of Elocution

READING

- ☐ Hold the book in the left hand and turn pages with the right.
- ☐ Hold the book flatly open, so as to not cover your face.
- ☐ Address the eye to your hearers at times.
- ☐ Pronounce one thought at a time – don't run-on.

ORATION

- ☐ Take your position with grace; pause and bow before starting.
- ☐ Don't be in a haste to begin, assume a leisurely grace.
- ☐ Imagine being surrounded by the imagery of your subject.

RECITATION

- ☐ Harmonize your voice with the poet's rhythm.
- ☐ Make the sound an *echo to the sense*.
- ☐ Accommodate pronunciation to suit the rhythm.

Bold, Proper and Elegant Pronunciation

Distinct Articulation

Variety in the voice

Proper Accentuation

Natural Emphasis on Significant Words

Justified Pause and Cadence

Accompanied Emotions by Tones and Gestures

*“Make sure you’ve finished speaking
before
your audience has finished listening.”*

- Dorothy Sarnoff

Thank You!

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